

Who Sustains Faculty Development for Transferable Skills?

Lessons from Israeli Higher Education

Dr. Yael Granot-Bein



The Edmond de Rothschild
Bridge for Higher Education
and Employment



Who is responsible for helping faculty teach transferable skills?

- Faculty themselves?
- Teaching and Learning Centers?
- Institutional leaders?
- National organizations?
- Or all of them together?



Universities are increasingly expected to develop graduates who can think critically, collaborate effectively, communicate clearly, learn independently, and work alongside AI.

Yet most faculty members were never trained to teach these capabilities.



What faculty tell us?

Faculty attitudes toward skills integration
(Samuel Neaman Institute survey)



90% view
transferable skills as
highly important

61% have never
received formal
training

84% of non-
implementing
faculty express
interest in learning
how



Main barriers

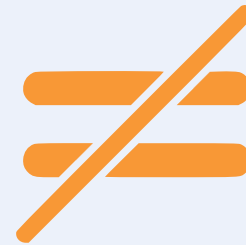
Lack of training

Lack of time

**Lack of
institutional
support**

The wrong assumption

**Understanding the importance
of skills**



Knowing how to teach them



Changing teaching practice

Who can sustain faculty development?



Four possible answers

1. **Individual faculty members.**
2. **Teaching and Learning Centers.**
3. **Institutional leadership.**
4. **National support structures.**

1. Individual Faculty Members

Strengths

- Academic autonomy
- Professional curiosity
- Personal motivation

Limitations

- Reaches mainly innovators.
- Difficult to scale.
- Depends on individual commitment.

Conclusion: Necessary but insufficient

2. Teaching and Learning Centers

Strengths

- Pedagogical expertise.
- Professional development.
- Coaching & consultation.
-
-

Limitations

- Limited authority.
- Limited resources
- Often reach only a small proportion of faculty.

Can teaching centers drive institutional change alone?

3. Institutional Leadership

7

Strengths

- Sets priorities.
- Allocates resources.
- Creates incentives.
- Shapes culture.

Without leadership support, faculty development rarely becomes institutional change.

4. National Infrastructure

Research has
national support
structures.

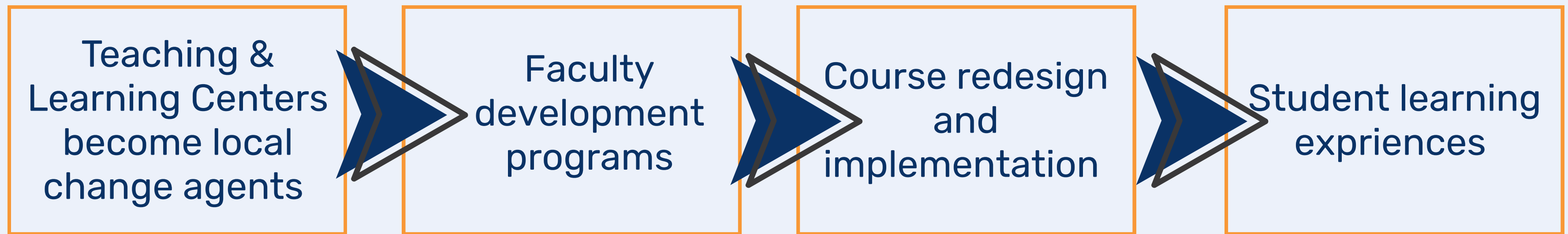
Teaching often does not.

Possible functions:

- Shared language
- Shared tools
- Shared professional learning
- Cross-institutional collaboration
- Capacity building

Marag Yeda:

Building Capacity Through Teaching and Learning Centers



23 higher education institutions; national community of practice; shared language and tools; peer learning; institutional implementation

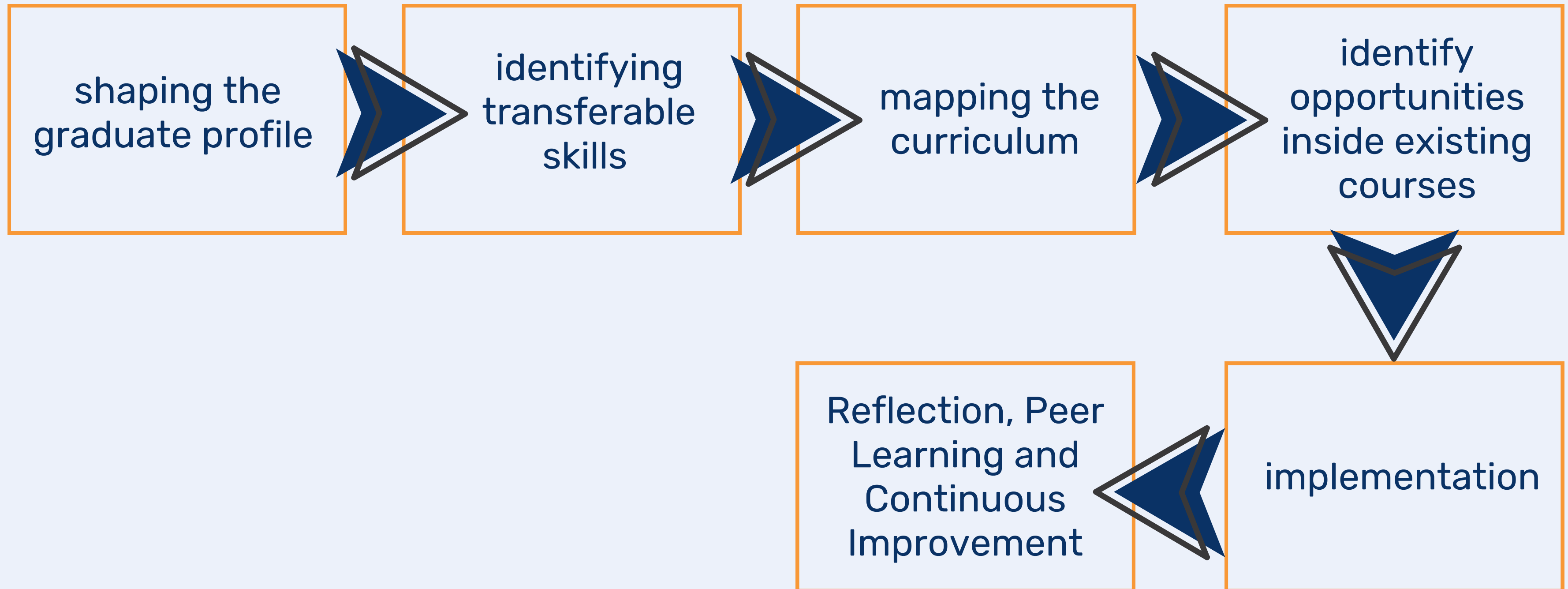
What helps faculty engage?

Language matters:
Not employability.
Not labor market rhetoric.
reframing often changes
the conversation

**Faculty engage when
skills are connected to:**

- Academic excellence
- Research
- Student learning
- Disciplinary identity

Our model for faculty training:



The questions we ask faculty

- Where are students already practicing these skills in your class?
- Where are missed opportunities?
- How can skills become visible?
- How can students practice intentionally?
- How can skills be assessed?



3 key takeaways

Faculty are more willing than we often assume.

Teaching and Learning Centers are essential, but cannot do this work alone.

Sustainable faculty development requires alignment between faculty, institutions and national support structures.